

Genesis 1:1 - Hebrew Handwriting & Reading Practice

Learn the word, say every letter name, notice what each mark does, then write it.

בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֶת הָאָרֶץ:

Pronunciation: B'reshit bara Elohim et ha-sha-MA-yim v'et ha-ARETZ.

Meaning: In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth.

Word order

#	Hebrew	Transliteration	Pronunciation	Meaning
1	בְּרֵאשִׁית	B'reshit	b're-SHEET	in the beginning
2	בָּרָא	bara	ba-RA	created
3	אֱלֹהִים	Elohim	eh-lo-HEEM	God
4	אֶת	et	ET	direct-object marker
5	הַשָּׁמַיִם	hashamayim	ha-sha-MA-yim	the heavens
6	וְאֶת	v'et	v'ET	and [direct-object marker]
7	הָאָרֶץ	ha'aretz	ha-ARETZ	the earth

Genesis 1:1 - Word / Phrase 1

בְּרֵאשִׁית

Transliteration	B'reshit		
Pronunciation	b're-SHEET		
Meaning	in the beginning		
From / dictionary form	רֵאשִׁית	reshit - beginning / first	

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
בְּ	Bet	b	Sheva is very short or silent here. Dagesh makes Bet sound B, not V.
רִ	Resh	r	Tsere gives an 'ay/eh' sound.
אֵ	Aleph	silent / carrier	Aleph carries/separates the vowel sound; it is usually silent.
שִׁ	Shin / Sin	sh	Hiriq gives the 'ee' sound. Right-hand Shin dot makes SH.
יֹ	Yod	y / helper	Yod is Y here, or may help carry an 'ee' vowel.
תִּ	Tav	t	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:1 - Word / Phrase 2

בָּרָא

Transliteration	bara		
Pronunciation	ba-RA		
Meaning	created		
From / dictionary form	בָּרָא	bara - to create	

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
בְּ	Bet	b	Qamatz usually gives the 'ah/a' sound. Dagesh makes Bet sound B, not V.
רְ	Resh	r	Qamatz usually gives the 'ah/a' sound.
אֲ	Aleph	silent / carrier	Aleph carries/separates the vowel sound; it is usually silent.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:1 - Word / Phrase 3

אלהים

Transliteration	Elohim	
Pronunciation	eh-lo-HEEM	
Meaning	God	
From / dictionary form	אלהים	Elohim - God

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
א	Aleph	silent / carrier	Hatef Segol gives a quick 'eh' sound.
ל	Lamed	l	Holam gives the 'oh' sound.
ה	He (hay)	h	Hiriq gives the 'ee' sound.
י	Yod	y / helper	Yod is Y here, or may help carry an 'ee' vowel.
ם	Final Mem	m	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:1 - Word / Phrase 4

תא

Transliteration	et
Pronunciation	ET
Meaning	direct-object marker
From / dictionary form	תא et - direct-object marker

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
א	Aleph	silent / carrier	Tsere gives an 'ay/eh' sound.
ת	Tav	t	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:1 - Word / Phrase 5

הַשָּׁמַיִם

Transliteration	hashamayim		
Pronunciation	ha-sha-MA-yim		
Meaning	the heavens		
From / dictionary form	שָׁמַיִם	shamayim - heavens	

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
הַ	He (hay)	h	Patach gives the 'ah/a' sound.
שׁ	Shin / Sin	sh	Qamatz usually gives the 'ah/a' sound. Dagesh strengthens/doubles this consonant.
מַ	Mem	m	Patach gives the 'ah/a' sound.
יְ	Yod	y / helper	Hiriq gives the 'ee' sound.
ם	Final Mem	m	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:1 - Word / Phrase 6

וְאֵת

Transliteration	v'et
Pronunciation	v'ET
Meaning	and [direct-object marker]
From / dictionary form	וְאֵת וְאֵת v'et

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
יְ	Vav	v / vowel helper	Sheva is very short or silent here.
אֵ	Aleph	silent / carrier	Tsere gives an 'ay/eh' sound.
ת	Tav	t	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:1 - Word / Phrase 7

הָאָרֶץ

Transliteration	ha'aretz		
Pronunciation	ha-ARETZ		
Meaning	the earth		
From / dictionary form	אֶרֶץ	eretz - earth	

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
הָ	He (hay)	h	Qamatz usually gives the 'ah/a' sound.
אָ	Aleph	silent / carrier	Qamatz usually gives the 'ah/a' sound.
רֶ	Resh	r	Segol gives the 'eh' sound.
ץ	Final Tsadi	ts	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:1 - Put It All Together

Start at the RIGHT edge and move LEFT. Say the letter names and notice the vowel marks as you write.

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Copy the complete verse: